



Driver Education

Family Overview · Optima Academy Online

~4¼ hrs per week · ~50 min/day · semester

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. More lessons, simulations, and assessments are approved for this course than appear here, so scholars may see some variation in lessons, simulations, and assessments from course to course, and between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

ABOUT THIS COURSE

A Florida-aligned driver-education course built around safe, defensive driving. Scholars work through the rules of the road, vehicle control, the science of impairment, and how to share the road safely — and finish by sitting the Florida Class E knowledge final.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE

Course Introduction	~1 week
How the course works, grading, FL license requirements, and a note to families.	
Unit 1 — Driving Basics & Risk	~3 weeks
What it really means to drive, the IPDE process, sharing the road, speed, and hazard awareness.	
Unit 2 — The Language of the Road	~4 weeks
Signs, signals, pavement markings, school/construction zones, right-of-way, intersections, highways, railroad crossings.	
Unit 3 — Vehicle Control & Handling	~4 weeks
Vehicle systems, basic maneuvers, stopping distances, adverse conditions, emergencies, maintenance, and parking.	
Unit 4 — Alcohol, Drugs & Impaired Driving	~3 weeks
How alcohol and drugs affect the body, FL DUI laws, BAC science, peer pressure, and alternatives.	
Unit 5 — Sharing the Road & Florida GDL	~3 weeks
Pedestrians, cyclists, motorcycles, trucks, distracted/aggressive driving, and Florida's Graduated Driver License.	
Final Exam	~1 week
Florida Class E Knowledge Final.	

Capstone & projects. Each unit ends with a Summative Assessment; the course ends with the Florida Class E Knowledge Final.

A TYPICAL WEEK

- Several lesson pages (one per topic, e.g., "Speed," "BAC and the Science of Impairment").
- Decision-based activities and scenario challenges ("Spot the Risk," "Stopping Distance Calculator").
- A knowledge check after each lesson.
- A unit summative assessment at the end of each unit.

TIME COMMITMENT

250 minutes per week (master schedule)

- Lesson reading & video: ~20 min/day
- Scenario activity / decision challenge: ~20 min/day
- Quiz or assessment: ~10 min/day

Project and capstone weeks may run longer.

WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- Microsoft 365 / OneDrive account
- Microphone for voice-based work
- Reliable internet
- Florida-specific resources used throughout (FL DUI law, FL GDL system, FL Class E exam)

On-Demand vs. Live. On-Demand (asynchronous): self-paced with due dates for pacing; a teacher is available for support, feedback, and grading.

Live school: live-school scholars take the same course in Optima's VR campus with a teacher and classmates (daily for core courses). **Note.** The course is Florida-specific. Successful completion supports preparation for the Florida Class E driver license; an in-car driving component is not part of this course.